

PM-JAY (Ayushman Bharat) — Reference Summary

Reference summary compiled from public sources (early 2026) for a student demo. Figures may change; verify against the official portal before relying on them. Not an official document.

Overview

Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) is a national, fully government-funded health assurance scheme launched in September 2018. It aims to reduce the financial burden of hospitalisation on poor and vulnerable families and to provide cashless secondary and tertiary care.

Coverage

The scheme provides health cover of up to Rs 5,00,000 per family per year for secondary and tertiary hospitalisation at empanelled hospitals.

There is no cap on family size or age for eligible households. Pre-existing conditions are covered from the first day of enrolment.

Covered care includes hospitalisation charges, pre- and post-hospitalisation expenses, diagnostics, medicines, and defined treatment packages across specialties such as cardiology, oncology, nephrology, neurosurgery and orthopaedics.

Eligibility

Eligibility is based on the deprivation and occupational categories of the Socio-Economic Caste Census (SECC) 2011 for rural and urban households, targeting roughly the bottom 40 percent of the population. Citizens aged 70 years and above may be eligible for coverage irrespective of income under later expansions of the scheme.

Beneficiaries are identified through the official beneficiary portal and use an Ayushman card at empanelled hospitals.

Cashless process and caps

Treatment is cashless at empanelled hospitals: the hospital verifies the beneficiary, raises a pre-authorisation request, and the claim is settled by the insurer or trust after the treatment.

Package rates are fixed under the Health Benefit Package master; certain categories such as room rent and specific procedures follow defined limits, so patients should confirm the applicable package before admission.

Documents commonly required

Aadhaar of the beneficiary, ration card or SECC linkage, and the Ayushman card. A doctor's referral or admission slip and the hospital estimate are used at the time of pre-authorisation.

Where to verify

Official portals: pmjay.gov.in and the beneficiary portal at beneficiary.nha.gov.in. Helpline 14555.